EVERY SQUARE INCH • SCHOOL RESOURCE

School Educational Tour Planning Checklist

A stage-by-stage control document for safe, purposeful and well-governed educational journeys.

Designed for: School leadership, journey coordinators and trip leaders
Version: September 2026

Use alongside the school’s safeguarding, medical, inclusion, emergency and approval policies.

Purposeful journeys. Carefully planned. Confidently delivered.

How to use this resource

Work through each section with the relevant school stakeholders. Record decisions, name responsible owners and retain the completed copy with the journey file.

1. Learning purpose and approval

- ☐ Define measurable learning outcomes linked to curriculum, character, cultural or wellbeing goals.
- ☐ Confirm participant age range, inclusion needs, proposed dates, duration and preferred destination.
- ☐ Prepare an outline scope, preliminary budget and approval paper for school leadership.
- ☐ Appoint a trip leader, deputy and internal decision-maker with clear authority.

2. Provider and programme due diligence

- ☐ Verify legal business details, relevant licences/registrations and named operational contacts.
- ☐ Review safeguarding approach, staff screening process, supervision arrangements and code of conduct.
- ☐ Review insurance evidence, emergency assistance, transport standards and accommodation controls.
- ☐ Request references or evidence of comparable school journeys.
- ☐ Confirm subcontractors and responsibility for each service.

3. Risk and inclusion planning

- ☐ Complete activity-, destination-, transport-, accommodation- and free-time risk assessments.
- ☐ Identify medical, dietary, accessibility, learning and cultural needs; agree reasonable adjustments.
- ☐ Set staff-to-student ratios based on age, activity, environment and individual needs.
- ☐ Define rooming, night supervision, headcounts, buddy system and lost-person response.
- ☐ Check climate, altitude, water, food hygiene, local laws and communication constraints.

4. Commercial and booking controls

☐ Issue a written scope covering inclusions, exclusions, cancellation, payment schedule and price-change rules.

☐ Build a contingency allowance and confirm approval for emergency expenditure.

☐ Reconcile participant numbers, deposits, complimentary places and final payment deadlines.

☐ Confirm travel documents, permissions, consent, insurance and refund communications.

5. Parent and student communication

☐ Publish itinerary, learning purpose, costs, deadlines, behaviour expectations and contact protocol.

☐ Collect consent, passport/ID data, emergency contacts and confidential health information securely.

☐ Hold a parent briefing and student preparation session; record questions and agreed actions.

☐ Provide a packing list, prohibited items, luggage limits and money/device guidance.

6. Final readiness and close-out

☐ Complete final supplier reconfirmation, manifests, rooming, transport and emergency contact tree.

☐ Conduct teacher briefing and scenario rehearsal; distribute controlled copies of key documents.

☐ Run departure headcount and document checks.

☐ Record incidents, near misses, feedback, learning evidence and supplier performance after return.

☐ Close financial reconciliation and retain records according to school policy.

Journey record

Journey / destination _____

Proposed dates _____

Trip leader _____

Approval date _____

Review date _____

Final sign-off _____